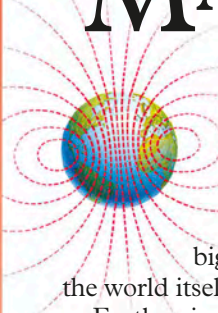




MAGNETS



Magnets are pieces of special material which have an invisible force that can push things away, or pull things towards them. The

biggest magnet of all is the world itself. Scientists think that as Earth spins around, electricity is made in the hot metal deep down in its center. This electricity gives Earth magnetic power. Earth has two magnetic poles, called the magnetic North and South Poles. Compass needles always point toward the magnetic North Pole.

Left out

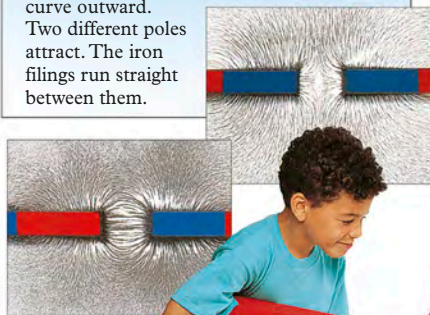
Magnets only attract some kinds of material. Not all metals are attracted by magnets.



Magnetic fields

A magnetic field is where a magnet has its power. If iron filings are sprinkled around a magnet, they gather together where the magnetic field is strongest. Two identical poles push each other away, so iron filings curve outward.

Two different poles attract. The iron filings run straight between them.



Magnets are fun to play with! These magnets are called horseshoe magnets because of their curved shape.

The area where the magnet has its power is called the magnetic field.